



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2023-24
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

The paper has four sections.

Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.

You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from any section of your choice.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of eight printed pages.

SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this section)

Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

- i) What does the poet mean by ‘jocund company’?
- a) The company of the cloud
 - b) The company of the valley and hills
 - c) The company of the daffodils
 - d) The bliss of solitude

ii) Which of the following lines contains the same literary device as the one in Wordsworth's *Daffodils*: "*They stretched in a never-ending line*"

- a) A hundred years should go to praise
Thine eyes and on thy forehead gaze;
- b) A fair breeze blow, the white foam flew
The furrow followed free,
- c) Because I could not stop for Death -
He kindly stopped for me -
- d) Frail as a dragon fly's wing

iii) Select the options that shows the correct relationship between statements (1) and (2) from *Daffodils*

- 1. When all at once I saw a crowd
A host of golden daffodils;
- 2. A poet could not but be gay,
In such a jocund company;

- a) 2 is the effect of 1.
- b) 1 is independent of 2.
- c) 2 is the example of 1.
- d) 1 is the effect of 2.

iv) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events in the correct order

- 1. The arrival of the Patriot was celebrated.
 - 2. The Patriot asks for the 'yonder sun' from his followers.
 - 3. The followers of the Patriot threw stones at him.
 - 4. He leapt at the sun to give it to his loving friends to keep.
- a) 1,3,4,2
 - b) 1,2,4,3
 - c) 1,2,3,4
 - d) 2,1,4,3

v) Who is the poet of *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings*?

- a) Maya Angelou
- b) David Roth
- c) Robert Browning
- d) Leigh Hunt

vi) The little girl in the story '*The Little Match Girl*' struck another match and she found herself sitting under _____.

- a) a hemlock tree
- b) a Christmas tree
- c) a mulberry tree
- d) a banyan tree

vii) The first vision as seen by the Little Girl in the short story, *The Little Match Girl* was:

- a) An iron stove with brassware
- b) An iron stove with polished iron knobs and polished brass ornaments
- c) An iron stove with polished brass knobs and brass ornaments
- d) Polished brass stove with polished iron knobs and brass ornaments

viii) Why did the crocodile eat stones?

- a) There was no specific reason. They just swallowed it involuntarily.
- b) To aid digestion.
- c) They wanted their stomachs to be heavy. It helped them stay submerged in water.
- d) They swallowed it when they were very hungry and couldn't find any food.

ix) How did the baby crocodile prosper?

- a) By escaping the birds of prey and the lions
- b) By storing its food in holes
- c) By escaping the birds of prey and great herbivorous animals.
- d) By escaping the birds of prey and great carnivorous animals, catching all the food he needed and storing it till putrid in holes in the bank.

x) Sibia couldn't wear a necklace made of *lal lal beeges* because _____.

- a) *Lal lal beeges* were very expensive.
- b) The family needle had snapped.
- c) The great famine had destroyed all crops.
- d) All of the above.

xi) How will Antonio respond to '*The very tyranny and rage*' of Shylock?

- a) With a quietness of spirit
- b) With fury and rage
- c) With eagerness
- d) With revenge

xii) *Shylock: "Gaoler, look to him: tell not me of mercy."*

Who is '*him*'?

- a) Bassanio
- b) Launcelot
- c) Balthazar
- d) Antonio

xiii) *Portia : I stand for sacrifice;. The rest aloof are the Dardanian wives.*

Who does Porta compare herself to in this line?

- a) Cressida
- b) Thisbe
- c) Hesione
- d) Midas

xiv) What does Jessica trade the turquoise ring for?

- a) Monkey
- b) Other jewellery
- c) For a boat ride to Portia's house
- d) For cute cat.

xv) Why does Portia agree to help Antonio?

- a) because both Antonio and Portia carry an equal portion of love for each other
- b) because both Antonio and Bassanio carry an equal portion of love for each other and love to spend time with each other. Bassanio is therefore like Antonio.
- c) Antonio is kind.
- d) Portia and Bassanio hate Shylock.

xvi) Why does Portia send Balthazar to her cousin in Padua?

- a) to collect notes and a letter
- b) to deliver a letter and some garments
- c) She wanted Bathazar to check on Doctor Bellario as he was unwell.
- d) to deliver a letter to Doctor Bellario and collect notes and garments.

SECTION B

DRAMA (The Merchant of Venice- Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Shylock: Bespeak him a fortnight before. I will have,
the heart of him, if he forfeit; for were he out of
Venice, I can make what merchandise I will.*

- i) Where is this scene taking place? Who is Shylock speaking to? Where does Shylock want to meet the listener soon after? [3]
- ii) What is the unproven rumour that Salarino has heard? What does he wish soon after regarding Antonio? [3]
- iii) What does Shylock accuse Salarino and Salanio of? According to Salarino, what is the difference between Shylock and Jessica? [3]
- iv) What reasons does Shylock give for his hatred of Antonio? [3]
- v) List one good and one bad news that the listener had brought for Shylock. How does this scene contribute towards the progress of the plot? [4]

Question 3

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

Antonio: *I have heard
Your grace hath ta'en great pains to qualify
His rigorous course; but since he stands obdurate
And that no lawful means can carry me
Out of his envy's reach...*

- i) Where does this scene take place? Who is being referred to as 'His'? Who is Antonio speaking to? [3]
- ii) What is 'His' obdurate about? According to the listener, what would 'His' do at the last minute? What effect would the misery of Antonio have on the Turks and the Tartars? [3]
- iii) 'His' tells the listener a little later:

*You'll ask me why I rather choose to have
A weight of carrion flesh than to receive
Three thousand ducats. I'll not answer that
But say it is my humour; is it answer'd?*

What examples does he give to prove his point? [3]

- iv) What examples does Antonio give to Bassanio to prove that it is pointless pleading to 'His' against his decision? [3]
- v) What amount does Bassanio offer to "His' soon after to save the life of Antonio? What is the answer of 'His'? What is your impression of Shylock from this scene? Illustrate your answer with textual justification. [4]

SECTION C

PROSE- SHORT STORIES

(Treasure Trove- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

She crept along, shivering and hungry, the picture of misery, poor little thing!

- i) Describe the physical appearance of 'she'? Why couldn't she go home that day? [3]
- ii) On which day of the year does the story take place? Describe the weather on that day. Whose slippers was 'she' wearing? [3]
- iii) Where did 'she' huddle herself? Why do you think she hasn't been given a name? [3]
- iv) Describe the second vision seen by 'she'. [3]
- v) What happens when a star falls? Describe the grandmother of 'she'. If you had to change the ending of the story, what would it be? [4]

Question 5

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

“She had never owned even one anna-not a pice, not a pi, even, to buy, say, a handful of blown glass beads from that stall in the bazaar where they were piled like stars, or one of the thin glass bangles that the man kept on a stick, and you could choose which colour you’d have. She knew what finery was, though. She had been with her parents and brothers all through the jungle to the little town at the railhead where there was this bazaar.”

- i) Who is ‘she’? Describe her meal. [3]
- ii) What did the women do to save themselves from the crocodile while crossing the river? What did they collect? Who would they sell what they had collected? [3]
- iii) When did the Gujars move from one place to another? [3]
- iv) Mention any three household work that Sibia used to do since she could toddle. [3]
- v) List some items seen by ‘she’ in the bazaar. What reward did ‘she’ find at the end of the story. What is your impression of Sibia? Justify. [4]

SECTION D

POETRY

(Treasure Trove- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*The free bird thinks of another breeze
and the trade winds soft through the sighing trees
and the fat worms waiting on a dawn bright lawn
and he names the sky his own.*

- i) Which other kind of bird is mentioned in the poem? Whom do these two kinds of birds represent? [3]
- ii) How has the free bird been described in the first stanza of the poem? [3]
- iii) How does the other kind of bird sing? Describe the physical condition of the other bird. [3]
- iv) What does the other bird sing about? Where is the song heard? Why is the ‘trill’ fearful? [3]
- v) Explain the phrase ‘grave of dreams’. What emotion does this poem evoke in you? Justify your reason with textual examples. [4]

Question 7

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*And I think, by the feel, my forehead bleeds,
For they fling, whoever has a mind...*

- i) Who is referred to as 'I'? Where is he being taken? [3]**
- ii) How was 'I' welcomed a year ago? [3]**
- iii) What had 'I' done for his loving friends? Why were his loving friends ill-treating 'I' after a year? [3]**
- iv) What did 'repel' 'I'? What did he ask his loving friends to do instead? How were the house-tops described a year after? [3]**
- v) What treatment was meted to 'I' a year later of him being celebrated by his 'loving friends'? What is one prominent theme of the poem? Justify with textual references. [4]**